ART

A Brush with **Cubism**

Deconstructed Realms, a new exhibition at DAG Delhi, offers a window into Indian artists' engagement with Cubism



onwards, 'Post-Independence' looks at the practice of artists in the post-Independence era who experimented with Cubist forms. 'Reflections of a New Nation' explores the themes of identity, spirituality and socio-political change, while the concluding section, 'Abstracted Realities', delves into mythical visual spaces.

Featuring more than a hundred works of over 40 artists, including those of Gaganendranath Tagore, Nandalal Bose, Laxman Pai, Jyoti Bhatt, George Keyt and others, the exhibition also attempts to trace the introduction of Cubism among Bengal artists. "For instance, Gaganendranath Tagore's assimilation of Cubism within the folds of the Bengal School wash style came to reflect a multiplicity of narratives and forms, steering the course towards a modernism that appealed to both its creator and viewer," adds Anand. The show also highlights rare works by Chittaprosad that reimagine landscapes and figures through a Cubist perspective. One of the most phenomenal works derived from Cubist etymology—Ramkinkar Baij's cement sculpture of Rabindranath Tagore, 'The Poet'—is also on view at the showcase.

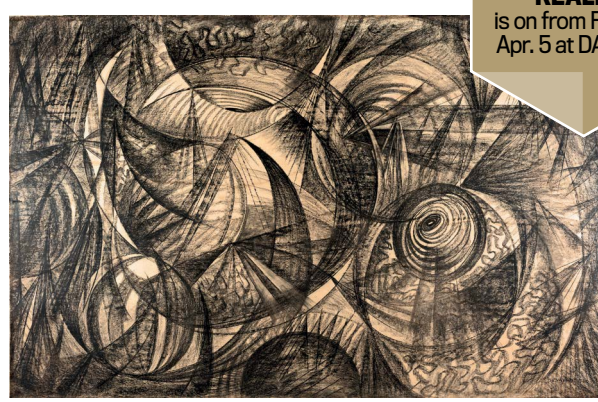
While there are works in oil and watercolour, some are in charcoal. "There are also Ram Kumar's lithographs featuring his brief tryst with figuration in Europe. Besides, you will discover sculptures—in cement, terracotta, wood and papier-mache. You will also find Piraji Sagara's reliefs using enamel and mixed media on wood," points out Anand. The exhibition at DAG has an accompanying publication with essays by Dr Kathleen Wyma, R. Siva Kumar and Shatadeep Maitra in which they investigate Cubism's evolution from Europe to India, its role in asserting cultural identity and other themes.

Following its tenure in Delhi, the exhibition will move to DAG's galleries in Mumbai. "We also want to collaborate with some of our partner museums and institutions to take it to different cities across India," says Anand. ■

–Geetika Sachdev

DECONSTRUCTED REALMS
is on from Feb. 8 to Apr. 5 at DAG Delhi





THE AWAKENING (clockwise from top) 'Milkmaid' by J. Sultan Ali; 'Untitled (The Effect of the Moon)' by Devyani Krishna; and 'Untitled' by Shanti Dave